Where do your first players come from?

A two-minute check for small indie teams.
Tick what's true today.



1 What can people outside your team play right now?

- ☐ Nothing yet
- ☐ Screenshots or a trailer
- ☐ A build a few people tried
- ☐ A public demo

Sets your version of the move on the back.

2 Who are your first 100 players?

- ☐ Not sure yet — WHO
- ☐ A guess we haven't tested — WHO
- ☐ We've seen them confirmed

3 Which fits best right now?

- ☐ Nobody outside our circle has played it — SEEN
- ☐ A few have, but we can't reach more — SEEN
- ☐ People find it, but few play or come back — PLAY
- ☐ A small group plays with us, but it doesn't grow — GROW

4 After someone plays, what happens next?

- ☐ Nothing, they're gone — KEEP
- ☐ We get feedback, but can't reach them again — KEEP
- ☐ They follow us or leave contact details
- ☐ They join where we keep talking

KEEP ☐ WHO ☐ SEEN ☐ PLAY ☐ GROW ☐

Ticked KEEP? Start there. Otherwise WHO. Otherwise your tag from question 3. Turn over →

Your first move

KEEP

Looks like:	People play it, then they're gone.
First move:	**Every time you show the game, give people a way back: a feedback button in the build, plus one place to follow you (a Discord, a newsletter or a Steam follow).**
Signal:	How many players leave you a way to reach them.
Move on when:	Most people who play leave a way back.

WHO

Looks like:	You can't yet picture who your first players are.
First move:	**Pick three games like yours. Read 50 recent Steam reviews of each and note what players love and what they miss, in their words.**
Signal:	You can describe your players in their own words.
Move on when:	You know where they already talk.

SEEN

Looks like:	Too few people outside your circle know the game exists.
First move:	**Put your Steam page up early as the one place everything points to. Then get into one festival and send a build or clip to five small streamers who play games like yours.**
Signal:	Wishlists and follows per week from people you don't know.
Move on when:	Strangers find you every week.

PLAY

Looks like:	People notice the game, but few play, give feedback or come back.
First move:	**Run a small gated playtest (Steam Playtest or Discord waves) with one question per build. Then tell testers what you changed.**
No build yet:	Let 10 followers choose between two directions, then show them what you picked.
Signal:	How many come back for the next build.
Move on when:	Testers return without being chased.

GROW

Looks like:	A small group plays and talks with you, but it doesn't grow.
First move:	**Give your most active players a reason to bring others: an early build to share with one friend, a role, or priority for people they invite.**
No build yet:	Give your five most active followers an early look to pass on.
Signal:	New people arriving through existing members.
Move on when:	Your newest players came through other players.

Go public with a demo once people are already waiting for it. A small playtest first gets things moving.

One thing we'll try: _____

How we'll know it worked: _____

Check again on: ___ / ___

Want a first move for your exact stage?

Take the free 5-minute diagnostic.

Communitygeeks · communitygeeks.ai

https://tally.so/r/bZZQ1e?ref=a4

Sources: Valve Steamworks documentation · How To Market A Game (Chris Zukowski) · GameDiscoverCo